

## What Backward Negative Concord Tells Us About Control

**Abstract.** In this article, I propose an analysis of a phenomenon I call Backward Negative Concord (BNC). This is when a negative concord item in a matrix clause is licensed by negation in an embedded clause, contra expectations of standard negative concord requiring clausemate negation or at the very least the c-command of negation. It is shown that BNC appears in control structures in Russian if the NCI is the controller. Based on the generalization that a CP layer in the control complement is required I propose that the complementizer introduces a [uNEG] feature that gets transmitted to the controller. It is also demonstrated that an embedded CP layer is a necessary but insufficient condition for BNC. Finally, cases of BNC occurring with what look like raising verbs are discussed together with their differences from BNC in control structures.

**Keywords.** Obligatory Control, (Strict) Negative Concord, Russian *ni*-phrases

**1. Introduction.** Russian is a strict negative concord language. That is, *ni*-phrases can only occur in the presence of a clausemate negation.<sup>1</sup>

- (1) a. Nikto \*(ne) smotrit televizor.  
nobody NEG watches TV  
'Nobody watches TV.'
- b. \*Lina ne думаet [čto nikto smotrit televizor].  
Lina NEG thinks that nobody watches TV  
Int.: 'Lina doesn't think that anyone watches TV.'

Kholodilova (2015), Letuchiy (2017) notice that there seem to be exceptions to that rule. They notice that, in some subject control cases, *ni*-pronouns are licensed in the matrix clause when the negation is in the embedded clause (2). Let us call this phenomenon Backward Negative Concord. Kholodilova (2015) proposes an analysis of the phenomenon based on pragmatics-driven bleaching (Partee et al. 2011). Letuchiy (2017) reduces some of the cases to raising.

- (2) from Kholodilova (2015)  
**Nikto** staralsja [ob etom **ne** vspominat'].  
Nobody tried about this NEG recollect  
'Everyone tried not to think of it.'

Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020), building on Minor (2013), show that a large class of object control verbs allow the same: a *ni*-pronoun can be licensed in the position of matrix object in the presence of embedded negation. They propose to analyze these instances of *ni*-pronouns as negative floating quantifiers which are located in the embedded clause and are licensed by clausemate negation.

In this article, I propose an analysis of the data on BNC. I also discuss the broader consequences that the BNC data has for the theory of control and Agree. I consider both the subject

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1. Abbreviations: NOM Nominative, ACC Accusative, DAT Dative, INF Infinitive, NEG Negation, PFV Perfective, IPV Imperfective, NCI Negative Concord Item

and object control cases of this phenomenon. I call this Backward Negative Concord - cases in which a Negative Concord Item is allowed to appear in the matrix clause while negation is only present in the embedded clause. I provide additional data on the kind of control predicates that do and do not allow Backward Negative Concord. I also show that the only matrix position in which a Negative Concord Item can be licensed by embedded negation is the position of the controller. I argue, based on structure diagnostics (introduced in Section 3.1), for the generalization that

- (3) A control complement needs a CP layer for BNC to be possible.

Departing from this generalization, adding case transmission and independence facts in Russian control structures (Landau 2008), I then argue against an account based on the movement theory of control (Hornstein 1999). Departing from both an agreement theory of negative concord (Zeijlstra 2004) and agreement theory of control (Landau 2001, Landau 2013, Landau 2015), I then consequently argue that BNC structures provide evidence for a bidirectional view of feature transfer under Agree (Deal 2022, Clem & Deal 2024). Specifically, I propose, following Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023), that CP control complements in Russian can have a complementizer bearing a [ $\mu$ NEG] feature. That feature gets checked by clausemate negation and transmitted to the controller through PRO, yielding BNC structures.

The article is organized as follows. In Section 2, I present the basic data on BNC in control complements in Russian. Additional data is available in the Appendix. Section 3 contains a discussion of the properties of the examined structures and motivates a generalization about the kinds of predicates allowing BNC. Section 4 presents the analysis I propose for these structures. Section 5 goes over some predictions of the current proposal that turn out to be borne out and spells out the cross-linguistic consequences of the proposal. Section 6 discusses the special case of *try*-class predicates. I discuss some cases that reveal additional restrictions on when BNC can be allowed in Section 7. This Section also contains data on how BNC interacts with what look like subject raising predicates in Russian. Section 9 concludes the article. The appendix contains additional data for different control predicates with respect to BNC.

## 2. The phenomenon.

2.1. OBJECT CONTROL. Object control predicates in Russian allow for a *ni*-pronoun (a Negative Concord Item) to be in object position even when negation is only present in the embedded clause. Cases in which an NCI is present in the matrix clause and negation is only present in the embedded clause I will henceforth call Backward Negative Concord (BNC).

- (4) Context: Petya is not a morning person and isn't ready to communicate until after breakfast.  
 Petja naučil **nikogo** [ne približat'sja k nemu do zavtraka].  
 Petya taught nobody.ACC NEG approach.INF to him before breakfast  
 'Petya taught everyone not to approach him before breakfast.'
- (5) Context: the locker room where kids usually store bags will be undergoing renovation over the weekend.  
 Učitel' napomnil **nikomu** [ne ostavljat' sumki v razdevalke].  
 teacher reminded nobody.DAT NEG leave.INF bags in locker.room  
 'The teacher reminded everyone not to leave their bags in the locker room.'

- (6) Trener predupredil **nikogo** [ne prinitat' steroidy nakožnym sposobom].  
coach warned nobody.ACC NEG take.INF steroids cutaneous method  
'The coach warned everybody not to apply steroids cutaneously.'

Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020) provide lists of object control predicates showing BNC:<sup>2</sup>

- (7) Speech act causation verbs allow BNC (Lyutikova & Tatevosov 2020:96)  
*velet* 'to order', *prikazat* 'to order', *dozvolit* 'to allow', *pozvolit* 'to permit', *posovetovat* 'to advise', *porekommendovat* 'to recommend', *poprosit* 'to ask', *razrešit* 'to permit', *poručit* 'to entrust'...
- (8) Implicative causation verbs allow BNC (Lyutikova & Tatevosov 2020:96)  
*vynudit* 'to compel', *zastavit* 'to force', *objazat* 'to oblige', *prinudit* 'to compel', *pomoč* 'to help', *pomešat* 'to hinder', *dat* *vozmožnost* 'to enable/give opportunity'...
- (9) Conative<sup>3</sup> speech act verbs allow BNC (Lyutikova & Tatevosov 2020:97)  
*ugovarivat* 'to talk.into', *uprašivat* 'to beg', *umol'at* 'to plead', *soblazn'at* 'to tempt', *zamanivat* 'to entice'...

Out of these predicates, the only ones that could plausibly be analysed as ECM predicates are the speech act causation verbs in (7) since they are the only ones showing other evidence of embedded scope of the object (see Minor (2013), Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020)). The exact analysis of these aside, I take the fact that all the other object control verbs license BNC to show that BNC requires a separate analysis. Summing up, Backward Negative Concord seems to be licensed with any object control verb.

## 2.2. SUBJECT CONTROL.

2.2.1. ATTITUDE PREDICATES. Subject control verbs selecting attitudinal complements license Backward Negative Concord. In all the examples below, the negative quantifier 'nobody' is interpreted as a universal quantifier in the matrix clause scoping over the negation in the embedded clause.

- (10) **Nikto** rešil [ne prixodit']  
nobody.NOM decided NEG come.INF  
'Everyone decided not to come.'
- (11) **Nikto** nadejalsja [ego zdes' bol'she ne uvidet'].  
nobody.NOM hoped he.ACC here anymore NEG see.INF  
'Everyone hoped not to see him here again.'

Importantly, in the examples above, the NCI subject is interpreted in the matrix clause. Apart from the interpretations, this can also be seen in (12).

2. see Appendix for examples illustrating BNC with predicates in (7)–(9)

3. These are verbs that, in imperfective aspect, denote attempts, while denoting accomplishments in perfective aspect.

- (12) *Nikto<sub>i</sub>* v *svoe<sub>i</sub>* vremja rešil [ne prixodit’]  
 nobody.NOM in REFL time decided NEG come.INF  
 ‘Everyone in their own time mind decided not to come.’

Backward Negative Concord can be licensed with the following predicates (data for these predicates not shown in this Section is provided in the Appendix):

- (13) Attitude predicates allow BNC  
*rešit’* ‘to decide’, *nadejat’sja* ‘to hope’, *bojat’sja* ‘to fear’, *predpočitat’* ‘to prefer’, *planirovat’* ‘to plan’, *sobirat’sja* ‘to intend’, *xotet’* ‘to want’, *obeščat’* ‘to promise’, *riskovat’* ‘to risk’.

To show that these predicates take attitude predicates, I will use two diagnostics. Firstly, referential expressions give rise to the de re/de dicto ambiguity, and cannot be substituted equivalently. Say, Sasha’s old classmate Adel’ was just hired by Sasha’s employer, which Sasha is not yet aware of. In this case, (14a)  $\nRightarrow$  (14b). The same can be shown for all of the predicates above.

- (14) a. Sasha obeščal/ nadejalsja/ rešil [uvidet’sja s Adelem].  
 Sasha promised/ hoped/ decided meet.INF with Adel’  
 ‘Sasha promised/hoped/decided to meet with Adel’.
- b. Sasha obeščal/ nadejalsja/ rešil [uvidet’sja s novym kollegoj].  
 Sasha promised/ hoped/ decided meet.INF with new colleague  
 ‘Sasha promised/hoped/decided to meet with the new colleague’.

Another test used in Landau 2015 is based on the fact that indefinite DPs within attitude complements, unlike in nonattitude ones, do not have an existence entailment. In (15), there is no entailment of the existence of the apple in question. The same is true for all of the predicates above.

- (15) Sasha obeščal/ nadejalsja/ rešil [porezat’ jabloko].  
 Sasha promised/ hoped/ decided slice.INF apple  
 ‘Sasha promised/hoped/decided to slice an apple.’

To summarize, BNC is allowed with subject control predicates that select attitude complements.

2.2.2. RESTRUCTURING VERBS. Wurmbrand (2014) analyzes non-future subject control infinitives as involving (the most radical) restructuring. This includes aspectual verbs like *begin*, implicatives like *manage* and *try*-class predicates. This Section shows that implicative and aspectual subject control predicates do not allow Backward Negative Concord. *Try*-class predicates are discussed separately in Section 6.

*Uspet’* ‘to manage in time’, *zabyvat’* ‘to forget’ are implicative subject control verbs in Russian. They do not allow Backward Negative Concord (16)–(17).<sup>4</sup>

4. For all the ungrammatical BNC sentences in this article, the corresponding sentences with *vse* ‘all’/ *každyj* ‘every(one)’ as the subject instead of *nikto* ‘nobody’ are grammatical. This is shown explicitly for *zabyvat’* ‘to forget’ in (17). Thus, I take the ungrammaticality of *nikto* in the subject position to be due to its NCI status and not any other verb-specific factors.

- (16) Context: Multiple people were entering a cafe that had a cat nearby that was quick to try to sneak into the cafe after the person.

\*Nikto uspel [ne vpustit' košku].

nobody.NOM managed.in.time NEG let.in.INF cat

Int.: 'Everyone managed to (close the door behind them in time to) not let the cat in.'

- (17) a. Context: Vera is not very good at giving advice.

Vse (večno) zabyvali [ne slušat' Verinyx sovetov].

all always forgot NEG listen.INF Vera's advice

'Everyone kept forgetting not to listen to Vera's advice.'

- b. \*Nikto (večno) zabyval [ne slušat' Verinyx sovetov].

nobody.NOM always forgot NEG listen.INF Vera's advice

Int.: 'Everyone kept forgetting not to listen to Vera's advice.'

(18)–(19) show that aspectual predicates also do not license Backward Negative Concord.

- (18) ??Nikto načal [ne vpolnjat' plan].

Nobody began NEG fulfill.INF plan

Int.: 'Everyone started to not fulfill the (production) plan.'

- (19) \*Nikto prekratil/ perestal [ne slušat'sja].

nobody.NOM stopped stopped NEG obey.INF

Int.: 'Everyone stopped disobeying (=misbehaving).'

To summarize, restructuring predicates (except try-predicates, see discussion in Section 6) do not allow BNC.

2.3. BNC LICENSING CONDITIONS. In the BNC structures above the NCI is licensed in the matrix clause in the presence of negation in the embedded clause. As expected, the same NCIs become ungrammatical in the absence of embedded negation. This is illustrated for examples (87) and (10) repeated below in (20)–(21).

- (20) Žar zastavil nikogo [\*(ne) približat'sja k nemu].

heat forced nobody.ACC NEG approach.INF to him

'The heat made everyone not come close to him.'

- (21) Nikto rešil [\*(ne) prihodit'].

nobody.NOM decided NEG come.INF

'Everyone decided not to come.'

In all of the above examples of NCIs in the matrix clause getting licensed when the negation is in the embedded clause, crucially, the position in which such NCIs are licensed is the position of the controller. (22)–(23) show that NCIs are not licensed in other positions in these structures. In (22), only the object can be an NCI, while the subject cannot. In (23), only the subject can be an NCI while an NCI-adjunct can only be interpreted as having been scrambled from the embedded clause.

- (22) a. \***Nikto** poprosil/ ubedil Petju [ne uxodit'].  
 Nobody asked/ persuaded Petya.ACC NEG leave.INF  
 'Int.: Everyone asked/ persuaded Petya not to leave.'
- b. Petja poprosil/ ubedil **nikogo** [ne uxodit'].  
 Petya asked/ persuaded nobody.ACC NEG leave.INF  
 'Petya persuaded everyone not to leave./...asked for nobody to leave.'
- (23) a. #Petja [**ni na kakom zastol'e**] rešil [ne golosovat' za Putina].  
 Petya NEG at any dinner decided NEG  
 i.\*'At every/no dinner party, Petya made a decision not to vote for Putin.'  
 ii. 'Petya made a decision to vote for Putin at every dinner party.'
- b. **Nikto** rešil [ne golosovat' za Putina].  
 nobody.NOM decided NEG vote for Putin  
 'Everyone decided not to vote for Putin.'

To conclude the Section, BNC is licensed with any object control predicate and attitude subject control predicate. It is not licensed with restructuring subject control predicates. In all cases, the negative concord item is only licensed in the presence of embedded negation and only in the position of the controller.

**3. The structural divide in control complements.** In this Section, I motivate the generalization in (24) and assemble the necessary pieces for the analysis proposed in Section 4.

- (24) Backward Negative Concord is only licensed in infinitival complements for which there is evidence of a CP layer.

3.1. STRUCTURE DIAGNOSTICS. As we have seen, one large class of predicates allowing Backward Negative Concord is the class of object control predicates. Object control infinitives in Russian differ from subject control infinitives. A difference that has received a lot of attention since Comrie (1974), Babby (1998) is the availability of the 'second dative'. Agreeing Floating Quantifiers (*ves* 'all', and the semi-predicatives *odin* 'alone' and *sam* 'oneself') can only bear nominative case in subject control structures (25a) while having dative case in object control structures (25b) <sup>5</sup>.

- (25) a. Lev rešil [prijeti *odin*/ \**odnomu*].  
 Lev decided come.INF alone.NOM/ alone.DAT  
 'Lev decided to come alone.'
- b. Lev ubedil Stasa [prijeti *odnogo*/ *odnomu*].  
 Lev persuaded Stas.ACC come.INF alone.ACC/ alone.DAT  
 'Lev persuaded Stas to come alone.'

Importantly, these FQs agree in case with a clausemate DP they are predicated of. Based on this fact together with (i.) the fact that the default case of Russian predicates is instrumental, and

5. This dative was later shown by Landau (2008) to be optional and alternating with accusative for object control

(ii.) the fact that these FQs cannot be complements of *seem/consider*, which need to be non-case-agreeing predicates (Bailyn 2001), Landau (2008) concludes that ‘second dative’ has to come from agreement with PRO and is not a default case.

Independent of their stance on the source of ‘second dative’, accounts of the asymmetry between subject and object control complements are based on structural differences between them (Greenberg & Franks 1991, Babby 1998, Testelefs 2001). In particular, Babby (1998), Testelefs (2001), Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023) argue that object control complements are more structurally complex than subject control ones. In this article, I follow this literature together with the default assumptions about control complements and take object control complements to be CPs. As for the source of dative case on PRO, under this view, dative case availability correlates with the presence of a CP-layer in infinitives: it is available in clauses with the *čtoby* ‘to, in order to’ complementizer, *wh*-infinitives and embedded *yes/no* infinitives.

(26) a. from Franks (1990) as cited in Lyutikova & Gerasimova 2023:38

Ljuba priexala čtoby pokupat’ maslo samoj.  
 Lyuba arrived to buy.INF butter alone.DAT  
 ‘Lyuba arrived to buy butter herself’

b. from Lyutikova & Gerasimova 2023:38

Ljuba znaet kak pokupat’ maslo samoj.  
 Lyuba knows how buy.INF butter alone.DAT  
 ‘Lyuba knows how to buy butter herself.’

c. Valja ne znaet pokupat’ li maslo samoj.

Valya NEG knows buy.INF whether butter alone.DAT  
 ‘Valya doesn’t know whether to buy butter alone.’

I follow Landau (2008), Bailyn (2012), Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023) in assuming that it is the infinitival C that assigns dative to PRO. Thus, I will treat the availability of this type of dative as an indicator of the presence of a CP layer.

Another indicator of a CP layer in an infinitive, according to both Landau’s agreement model of control (Landau 2001) and the more novel two-tiered theory of control (Landau 2015, Landau 2016), is the availability of partial control. Under the agreement theory of control, partial control has to be mediated by the embedded C head. In fact, this coincides with the Russian-internal diagnostic laid out above: although normally subject control infinitives do not have a ‘second dative’, Landau (2008) shows that, in case of partial control, the dative appears and becomes obligatory.

(27) a. from Landau 2008:908

My predpočli sobratsja vse/ ??vsem v šest’.  
 we.NOM preferred to.gather all.NOM/ all.DAT in six.  
 ‘We decided to all gather at six.’

b. Predsedatel’ predpočel sobratsja vsem/ \*vse s šest’.

chair.NOM preferred to.gather all.DAT/ all.NOM in six  
 ‘The chair preferred to all gather at six.’

This suggests that contrary to traditional belief about complement size distinctions in Russian object and subject control infinitives, subject control predicates that allow partial control also contain a CP layer, which allows us to maintain (24).

That is independently argued for in Landau (2015): according to Landau, it is exactly attitude complements that allow PC. Based on the view that attitude predicates are quantifiers over sets of contexts, which are taken to be tuples of coordinates  $i = \langle \text{AUTHOR}(i), \text{ADDRESSEE}(i), \text{TIME}(i), \text{WORLD}(i) \rangle$ , Landau suggests that these coordinates may project in the syntax as a specifier of C. Namely, this is what happens to the  $\text{AUTHOR}(i)$  or  $\text{ADDRESSEE}(i)$  coordinate in obligatory control.

The analysis in Landau (2015) brings together Landau's generalizations that attitude complements, semantically tensed complements (those that allow temporal modification conflicting with the matrix one), and PC complements are the same set. Under this view, the availability of partial control relies on the logophoric nature of this type of control which is facilitated by the  $\text{AUTHOR}(i)$  or  $\text{ADDRESSEE}(i)$  coordinate projected in Spec,CP (see more discussion on predictive vs logophoric control in Section 4). The availability of conflicting temporal modification follows from attitudinality: the embedded context has its own set of coordinates, including  $\text{TIME}(i)$ .

Based on Landau's theory, attitudinality, the possibility of conflicting temporal modification and the availability of partial control can be added to the set of possible indicators of a CP layer in an infinitival complement. In the following subsection, I summarize the properties of predicates from 2 against the diagnostics discussed above.

3.2. DIAGNOSTICS RESULTS. In concordance with the claims in Landau 2015:19, attitudinal subject control predicates show evidence of complement tense independence. This includes all the attitudinal subject control predicates allowing BNC described in Section 2.2.1. This is shown for a couple of predicates in (89)).

- (28) Context: Valya went to a rally yesterday and there was a risk of him getting detained.  
**Včera** Valja božalsja/ riskoval [**segodnja** ne vyjti na rabotu].  
 yesterday Valya feared risked today NEG go.out on work  
 'Yesterday Valya feared/was risking not getting to work today.'

Subject control implicatives do not allow conflicting tense modifiers (29). The same is true of aspectual subject control predicates (30).

- (29) \***Včera** Sajana uspela [**segodnja** vernut'sja].  
 yesterday Sayana did.in.time today return.INF  
 Int.: 'Yesterday, Sayana managed to return today in time.'

- (30) \***Včera** Darina načala [**zavtra** rabotat'].  
 yesterday Darina began tomorrow work.INF  
 Int.: 'Yesterday, Darina began to work tomorrow.'

As for object control predicates, most of them allow conflicting temporal modification.<sup>6</sup> The one group that does not allow conflicting temporal modification is object control implicatives. These are classified in Landau (2015) as non-attitude verbs involving predicative control.

6. See Appendix for data confirming this and additional data for subject control cases.



(31) Implicative causation verbs

‘Yesterday, the teacher compelled/obliged Nastya to come to school today.’

Thus, we can now assess the relevant properties of infinitival complements of the verbs discussed in Section 2. They are summarized in Table 1. In the columns, ‘BNC’ shows whether Backward Negative Concord is licensed with the predicate in question, ‘Attitude’ shows whether the predicate takes attitude complements, the next column indicates whether temporal modification conflicting with the matrix one is possible in the complement (what Landau calls ‘semantically tensed’), the ‘PC’ column indicates whether partial control is possible with the corresponding predicates, the ‘Second dative’ column indicates the availability of dative FQs in the complement.

| Matrix predicate type                                                                                                          | BNC | Attitude | Conflicting T modification | PC | Second dative |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|----------|----------------------------|----|---------------|
| Subject control: <i>rešit</i> ‘decide’, <i>obeščat</i> ‘promise’, <i>nadejat’sja</i> ‘hope’, <i>sobirat’sja</i> ‘intend’ etc.. | ✓   | ✓        | ✓                          | ✓  | ✓ (with PC)   |
| Object control: <i>poprosit</i> ‘to ask’, <i>ubeždat</i> ‘to persuade’, etc..                                                  | ✓   | ✓        | ✓                          | ✓  | ✓             |
| Object control, implicatives: <i>zastavit</i> ‘to force’, <i>prinudit</i> ‘to compel’ etc..                                    | ✓   | ✗        | ✗                          | ✗  | ✓             |
| Subject control, restructuring: <i>načat</i> ‘begin’, <i>uspet</i> ‘manage.in.time’, <i>zabyt</i> ‘forget’                     | ✗   | ✗        | ✗                          | ✗  | ✗             |

Table 1. Structure size diagnostics and BNC licensing

It is important to note here again that all of the diagnostics utilized in this Section are unidirectional: the availability of ‘second dative’ or attitude complement selection is taken to signal the presence of a CP layer, while the unavailability of these does not necessarily entail the absence of a CP layer. The generalization (24) is made based on the data in Table 1. BNC is licensed only in infinitival complements that show evidence of being CPs. That is, it is necessary for the embedded complement to be a CP to make BNC possible. Note that this condition is a necessary but not sufficient one as evidenced by cases discussed in Section 7.

#### 4. Proposal.

4.1. THE ROLE OF C. The Generalization in (24) suggests that Backward Negative Concord is somehow facilitated by the CP layer. The clue as to how is hidden in the mechanism of another non-standard type of negative concord in Russian, namely long-distance negative concord (LDNC). In the spirit of what Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023) arrive at for LDNC, I propose that control complement CPs in Russian can have a kind of negative-concord complementizer bearing a [uNEG] feature which makes it possible to transmit it to the matrix clause later.

What is understood by strict negative concord is the licensing of NCIs by clausemate negation only. However, in Russian, this is not entirely accurate. *Ni*-elements, the NCIs, can be li-

censed by matrix negation across an infinitival clause border (Gerasimova et al. 2015, Lyutikova & Gerasimova 2023). This is what they refer to as long-distance negative concord.

The experimental study reported in Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023) shows that matrix negation can license NCIs in both subject and object control complements.<sup>7</sup>

- (32) a. from Lyutikova & Gerasimova 2023:55 ex.40a (translation provided by author)  
 Konsul'tant **ne** proboval [pomogat' **nikomu** v razvitii proekta].  
 adviser NEG tried/attempted help.INF nobody.DAT in developing project  
 'The adviser hasn't tried to help anyone with business project development.'
- b. from Lyutikova & Gerasimova 2023:55 ex.41a (translation provided by author)  
 Alina **ne** uprašivala Nikitu [kljast'sja **nikomu** v večnoj ljubvi].  
 Alina NEG persuaded Nikita.ACC swear.INF nobody.DAT in eternal love  
 'Alina wasn't persuading Nikita to swear his eternal love to anyone.'

Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023) propose that, in the case of licensing *ni*-pronouns across a CP boundary in Russian, the [*u*NEG] feature on the embedded *ni*-pronoun is associated with the [*i*NEG] feature on the matrix negative operator through a [*u*NEG] feature on C. Thus, it is proposed that the null C involved in obligatory control in Russian (selecting for untensed T and assigning dative) can bear a [*u*NEG] feature. The authors note that they are virtually positing a null negative complementizer in Russian, similar to overt negative complementizers found in other languages (McQuillan 2016 for Celtic languages, Laka 1990 for Basque). This 'negative' complementizer, however, differs in that it does not contribute (interpretable) negation. That is, in fact, the kind of complementizer that Landau (2002) posits for Hebrew, arguing that *me-* 'from' is a negative complementizer found in Hebrew infinitival control complements of verbs involving 'negative' meaning. He argues that like its finite counterparts in Basque, English, Spanish (Laka 1990, Laka 1992), Serbo-Croatian (Progovac 1993b), C has an interpretable [neg] feature. Landau proposes, that there is also another kind of infinitival negative complementizer in Hebrew – a null complementizer with an uninterpretable [neg] feature. This complementizer diffuses its uninterpretable [neg] feature by entering an Agree relation with Neg°.

I propose that such negative complementizer is the reason behind the apparent necessity of a CP-layer for Backward Negative Concord. The next Section summarizes the proposed mechanism of BNC.

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7. The object control verbs used in the experiment cover all the groups of object control verbs investigated in Section 2. The subject control verbs used in the experiment include aspectual verbs (*načínat'* 'to begin', *perestavat'* 'cease'), try-class predicates (*starat'sja* 'to try', *pytat'sja* 'to attempt', *probovat'* 'to try/attempt'), *riskovat'* 'to risk', and *toropit'sja* 'to hurry'. It can be shown that long-distance negative concord is also possible with other subject control verbs under examination in the current article.

- (i) a. Attitude verbs:  
 Konsul'tant **ne** bojalsja/ rešal/ obeščal [pomogat' **nikomu** v razvitii proekta].  
 adviser NEG feared decided promised help.INF nobody.DAT in developing project  
 'The adviser didn't fear/decide/promise to help anyone with business project development.'
- b. Implicatives:  
 Konsul'tant **ne** uspel/ zabył [pomoč' **nikomu** v razvitii proekta].  
 adviser NEG did.in.time forgot help.INF nobody.DAT in developing project  
 'The adviser didn't fear/love/refuse to help anyone with business project development.'

4.2. BACKWARD NEGATIVE CONCORD. In this article, I am adopting the structures proposed for control by Landau’s two-tiered theory (Landau 2015). According to Landau, there are two types of control. Nonattitude complements are ‘untensed’ (do not allow conflicting temporal modification), do not allow partial control, and exhibit predicative control. In these complements, the minimal pronoun subject (PRO) turns the complement into a predicate by moving to the specifier of a ‘predicative’ head in its left periphery.<sup>8</sup> Landau calls this head Fin (Rizzi 1997) and assigns it a [*u*D] feature responsible for attracting PRO in its specifier.

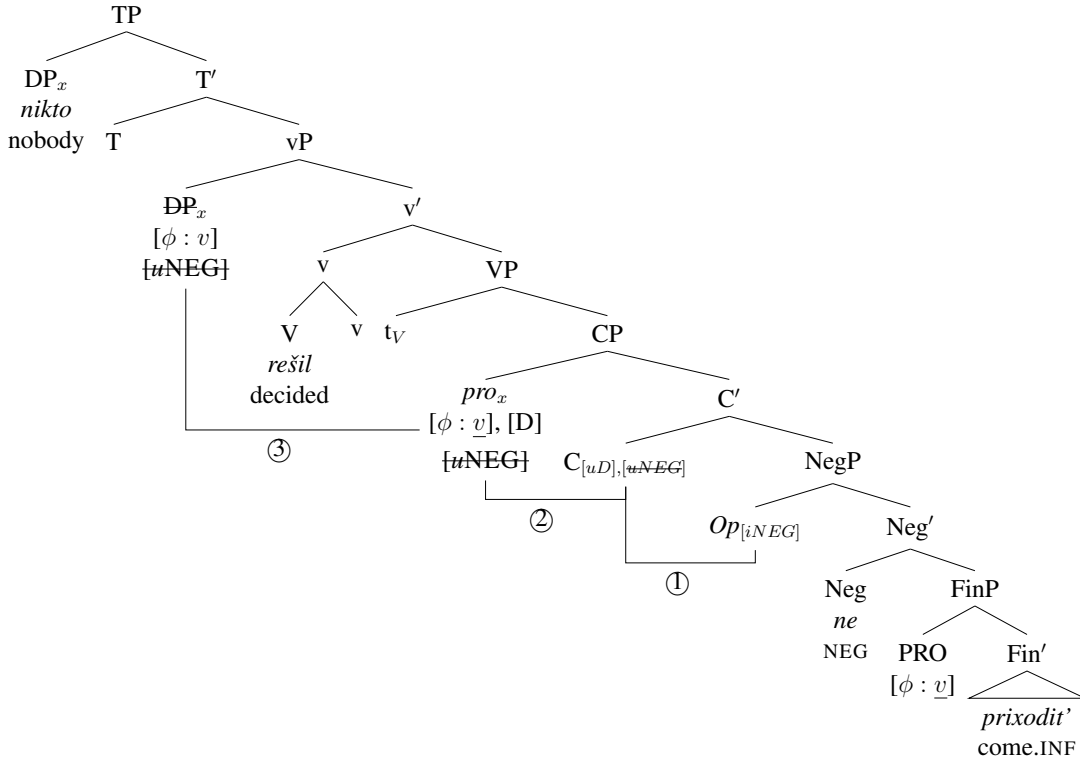
Attitude complements are ‘tensed’ (allow conflicting temporal modification), allow partial control, and exhibit logophoric control. In logophoric control, another step is added to the derivation of control structures. The predicate produced by PRO-movement as in predicative control is applied to a minimal pronoun (the coordinate AUTHOR(*i*) for subject control and ADDRESSEE(*i*) for object control) projected by C. This pronoun is bound by the controller in the matrix clause. Thus, in predicative control, control and agreement are established via predication. In logophoric control, they are established via predication and variable binding.

4.2.1. SUBJECT CONTROL CASES. Given the assumptions laid out, I can proceed to the proposal. As mentioned in Section 4.1, I propose that a C bearing a [*u*NEG] feature is responsible for making Backward Negative Concord possible. In a logophoric subject control complement, there is a C head that can bear a [*u*NEG] feature. That feature gets checked by clausemate negation. This C head, under Landau’s analysis, is responsible for projecting the *pro* to which the complement predicate is applied and which is bound by the subject of the main clause. I suggest that a C head bearing a [*u*NEG] feature gets it checked by clausemate negation and projects a *pro* with the same checked feature. This feature then gets transmitted to the controller when the relation valuating *pro*’s features is established. This derivation is illustrated in (33).

(33) Derivation of BNC with logophoric subject control (for (34))

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8. Landau notes that this idea can be tracked to Chomsky (1980) using PRO-movement to get syntactic predication in infinitival purpose clauses, Hendrick (1988) using it for relative clause formation and Clark (1990) extension of it to all obligatory control



- (34) Nikto rešil [ne prixodit']  
 nobody.NOM decided NEG come.INF  
 'Everyone decided not to come.'

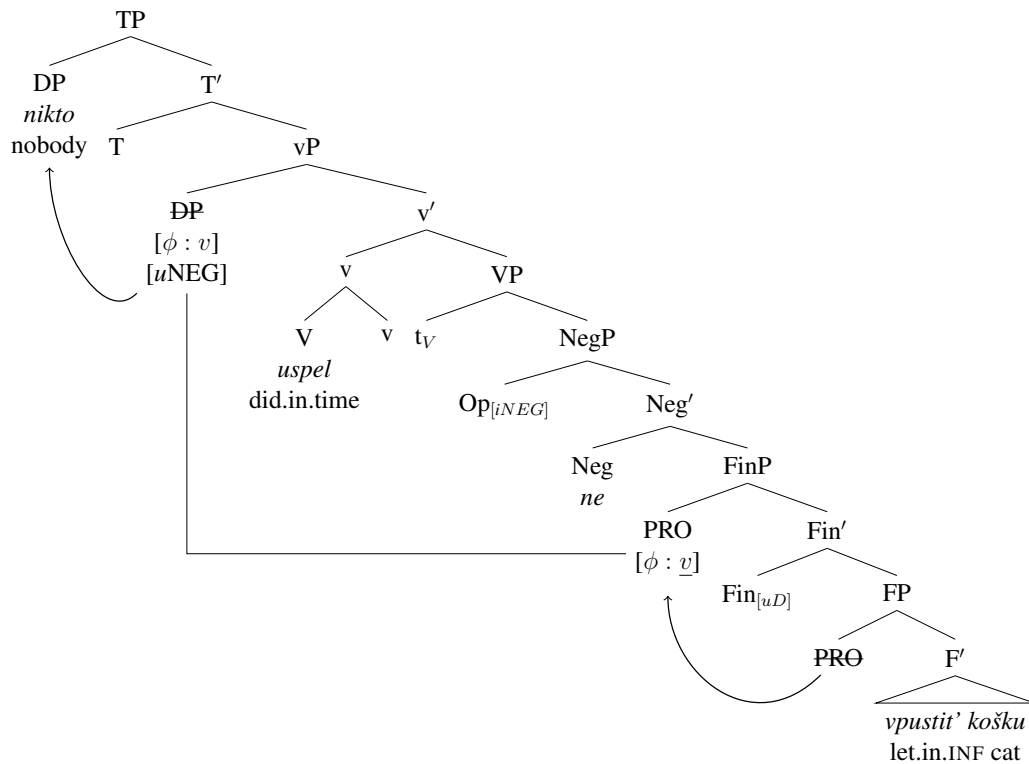
The derivation in (33) proceeds as follows. After PolP is built, a complementizer bearing a  $[uNEG]$  feature is merged. This complementizer is taken to be a separate lexical item that is (optionally) available in infinitival clauses. That feature gets checked against the  $[iNEG]$  feature on the negative operator ①<sup>9</sup>. Following Landau (2008), the complementizer in control structures also has a  $[uD]$  feature.  $C^\circ$  projects  $pro_x$ , which has a  $[D]$  feature. As a result of this probe-goal relationship between  $C^\circ$  and  $pro$ , the checked  $[uNEG]$  feature gets copied from  $C^\circ$  to  $pro$  ②. The next relevant stage of BNC derivation is the merger of the controller into the structure. When the Agree relationship between  $pro_x$  and  $DP_x$  is established,  $pro_x$  gets  $\phi$ -features from the controller and the controller gets the checked  $[uNEG]$  feature from  $pro_x$  ③. Importantly, this analysis follows the idea that the feature transfer occurring with Agree is transitive: in addition to the valuation of  $pro$ 's  $\phi$ -features 'from' the goal (=controller),  $pro$ 's own feature(s) are transmitted from

9. It is important to note at this point that placing a negation this high in the clause structure has undesirable consequences for syntactic analyses of genitive of negation in Russian that rely on a NegP placed low in the clause to assign GenNeg (Harves 2002, Bailyn 2004). That seems to be reconcilable with the proposed account of BNC if negation can be in two places in the clause structure. That is what Zeijlstra (2004), Zeijlstra (2008) argues for strict negative concord languages: the head hosting the negative marker is lower in the structure and also a concord item and has to agree with a higher negation. In this case, the lower negation (the one hosting the *ne* morpheme) could be the one responsible for GenNeg assignment. Gribanova (2017) also proposes a structure of the Russian clause that includes two loci of negation: a low NegP hosting the negative morpheme and a high PolP, Neg and Pol also undergo Agree in this proposal.

the probe to the goal. This is what Deal (2022) calls ‘goal flagging’ in opposition to probe valuation. The idea of bidirectionality of feature transfer under Agree stems from Chomsky (2001)’s treatment of case assignment and has been examined in a lot of work on Agree, especially in relation to case (Pesetsky & Torrego 2001, Pesetsky & Torrego 2007, Deal 2022, Clem & Deal 2024). In this article, I adopt this view of Agree.

Since subject control restructuring complements do not have a CP-layer, they do not exhibit BNC. In Landau’s system, these are the predicative control complements. I follow Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023) in assuming that the preverbal negative marker *ne* is the head of NegP, while the negative operator is hosted in Spec,NegP (the preverbal position is the result of post-syntactic lowering).

(35) Derivation of subject control BNC with restructuring predicates for (36)



- (36) \*Nikto uspel [ne vpustit' košku].  
 nobody.NOM managed.in.time NEG let.in.INF cat  
 Int.: ‘Everyone managed to (close the door behind them in time to) not let the cat in.’

In (35), FP represents the functional projection heading the complement infinitive. The exact extent of restructuring is not relevant to the current analysis: whatever FP is exactly, the C head, which can mediate backward negative control in the presence of negation in the embedded clause, is missing from this structure. Thus, the controller DP cannot get a checked  $[uNEG]$  feature as a result of Agree with PRO because PRO does not have it. If an NCI is merged into the

subject position with [ $\mu$ NEG], as is shown in (35), it can never get checked against negation because there is no local or c-commanding negation to Agree with. This leads to the crash of the derivation.

In order for the derivation in (33) to yield a sentence like (10) repeated below in (37) the controller has to start out as a non-negative quantifier. In this case a universal quantifier: Backward Negative Concord examples are equivalent to the same sentences with a universal quantifier in place of the *ni*-pronoun (37a=37b).

- (37) a. Nikto rešil [ne prixodit']  
 nobody.NOM decided NEG come.INF  
 'Everyone decided not to come.'
- b. Vse rešili [ne prixodit']  
 all.NOM decided NEG come.INF  
 'Everyone decided not to come.'

I suggest that this optionality stems from the optionality of [ $\mu$ NEG] on C. If the C in the derivation bears this feature, the resulting structure is spelled out as (37a), and if the C in the derivation does not have this feature, the structure is spelled out as (37b).

- (38) a. Derivation of (37a)  
 [Everyone<sub>[ $\mu$ NEG]</sub> decided [pro<sub>[ $\mu$ NEG]</sub> C<sub>[ $\mu$ NEG]</sub> Op<sub>[iNEG]</sub> not to come]]
- b. Derivation of (37b)  
 [Everyone decided [pro C Op<sub>[iNEG]</sub> not to come]]

This is essentially the same idea as what is proposed in Deal (2021) for Negative Concord Items. In this article, NCI licensing is reduced purely to morphological concord. The neg-morphology on the NCIs in this system is the result of indefinites interacting (undergoing Agree) with negation. Deal gives an example of an implementation of this Deal 2021:fn.6: a syntactic element [INDEF, HUMAN] that hasn't been 'flagged' with a [I | NEG] feature would be spelled out as a non-negative indefinite, while the element [INDEF, HUMAN, I | NEG] that bears some [I | NEG] feature received as a result of interacting with negation is spelled out as a Negative Concord Item (Italian *nessuno* 'nobody' in the case discussed in Deal (2021)).

Another assumption that is required concerns the interpretation of the NCI. Notice that in all of the translations in the examples the NCIs have a universal interpretation. Importantly, they cannot receive an existential reading.

- (39) Nikto rešil [ne prixodit']  
 nobody.NOM decided NEG come.INF  
 i. 'Everyone decided not to come.'  
 ii. \* 'Someone decided not to come'

In this article, I treat NCIs as positive universal quantifiers based on their interpretation in the examples above. This is in line with the view of NCIs as semantically non-negative argued for in Zeijlstra (2004), Zeijlstra (2008). Within the discussion of the quantifier status of NCIs (see

Ladusaw 1992, Zeijlstra 2008, Gajic 2016 a.o. for a view of NCIs as underlying existential; Giannakidou 2000, Shimoyama 2011, Rossyaykin to appear i.e. for a view of NCIs as underlying universal quantifiers<sup>10</sup>), I take the stance that is motivated by (39), that is, that universal interpretation is at the very least available for NCIs in Russian. In fact, BNC structures are taken to be evidence of the underlying universal quantifier status of NCIs by Rossyaykin (to appear). The matter of whether NCIs are always universals (as Rossyaykin (to appear) argues) is beyond the scope of the current article.

4.2.2. OBJECT CONTROL CASES. Having spelled out the mechanism behind Backward Negative Concord using the example of logophoric subject control, let me turn to the object control cases. The case of logophoric object control works in the same way as logophoric subject control. The only difference is that the controller that values *pro*'s  $\phi$ -features and receives the checked [*u*NEG] feature is the object of the matrix clause. Otherwise, the mechanism behind BNC is the one shown in (33): a complementizer carrying a [*u*NEG] feature is merged into the structure, checks this feature against the negative operator, transfers the checked feature onto *pro* that is projected in its specifier. The feature then gets transmitted to the controller from *pro* through the Agree relation established between them under the view of Agree that allows for bidirectional feature transfer between the probe and the goal.<sup>11</sup>

A case that hasn't yet been dealt with is predicative object control – the case of implicative object control predicates. As discussed in Section 3, these control complements also have a 'second dative' which is taken to be assigned by the infinitival C head. In this case, this C head itself acts as a 'predicative' head, attracting PRO to its specifier and, thus, creating a predicate out of the complement. In this case, if C bears a checked [*u*NEG] together with the [*u*D] feature responsible for attracting PRO, [*u*NEG] gets copied onto PRO as a result of that operation. It then gets transmitted to the controller from PRO when PRO's  $\phi$ -features get evaluated. This derivation is illustrated in (40). I follow Landau's structure where the controller and the infinitive are a specifier and a complement of a predicative head that he calls a relator (RP).

10. I thank Hedde Zeijlstra for pointing the issue of interpretation out to me.

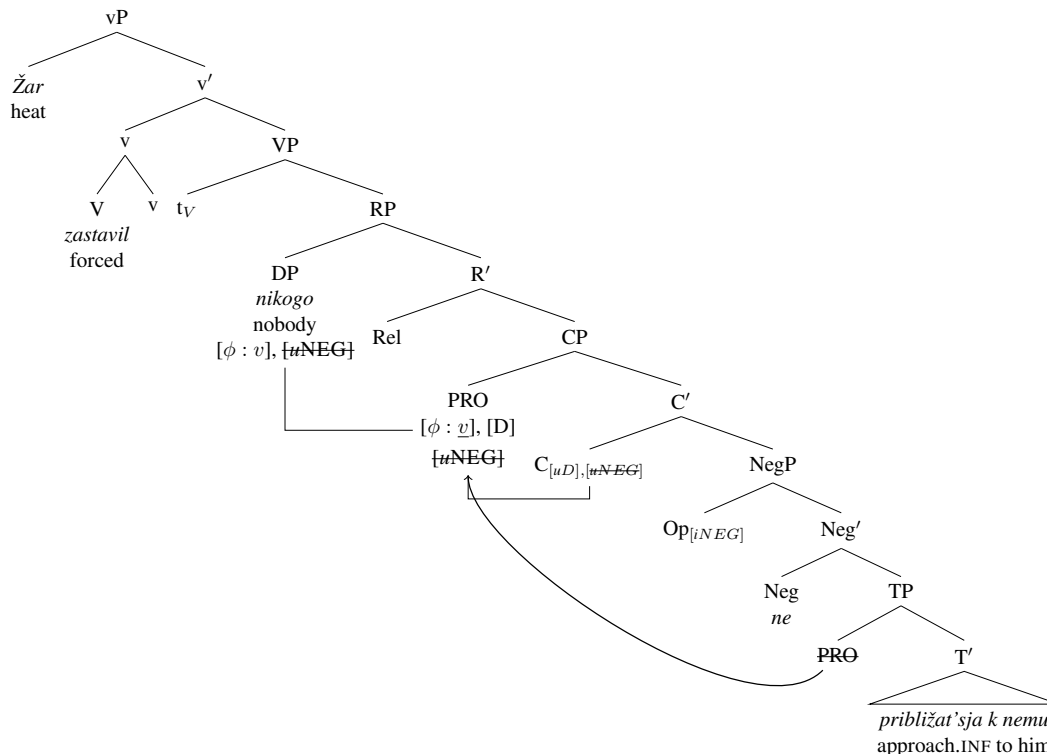
11. It is important to note here that for some attitude object control verbs in Russian there have been proposed ECM-type structures in which the surface controller is actually an overt embedded subject that gets case from the embedded clause (see Burukina 2020 for mandative predicates, Lyutikova & Tatevosov 2020 for speech act causative predicates). In the case of such structures, the controller-NCI licensing follows trivially since there is still (embedded) clausemate negation to take care of it. That being the case, the rest of object control predicates still require a separate mechanism to account for Backward Negative Concord. Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020) suggest that *ni*-pronouns that are seemingly objects in the matrix clause are actually embedded negative floating quantifiers. While that may be the case for some of the examples discussed in Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020), it doesn't seem to account for all of Backward Negative Concord situations. For one, the object does not have to be just the one *ni*-pronoun, it can be a full phrase *nikogo iz klientov* 'none of the clients' (1). Another reason I am rejecting this analysis is that the *ni*-pronoun and another floating quantifier don't have to agree in case. However, *ni*-pronouns used as NFQs always agree with their respective DP (in this case, PRO).

(i) a. Petja vynudil **nikogo** **iz klientov** ne uxodit.  
 Petja forced nobody.ACC of clients NEG leave.INF  
 'Petja forced all of the clients not to leave.'

b. Profesor predupredil **nikogo** ne podnimat' čemodan **samomu**.  
 professor warned nobody.ACC NEG lift.INF suitcase oneself.DAT  
 'Professor warned everyone to not lift the suitcase on their own.'

Thus I conclude that the general BNC cases with subject and object control should receive a uniform account.

(40) Derivation of BNC with predicative object control for (41) (based on Landau 2015:28)



(41) Žar zastavil nikogo ne približat'sja k nemu.  
 heat forced nobody.ACC NEG approach.INF to him  
 'The heat made everyone not come close to him.'

Thus, the coincidence of a neg-feature on C and the feature transfer under the Agree relationship between the controller and the controlled complement allows the controller to become an NCI in the presence of a negation in the embedded clause.

**4.3. MOVEMENT-BASED THEORY.** At first glance, there is an obvious possible account for Backward Negative Concord: an analysis along the lines of the movement theory of control (Hornstein 1999, Hornstein 2003). Thematic movement would explain the licensing of the *ni*-pronoun by embedded negation. Indeed, if the pronoun originated in the embedded clause then its  $[uNEG]$  feature would have been checked by clausemate negation. However, any movement-based theory of BNC would have to account for the split in the predicates with respect to BNC licensing. The data and generalizations provided in this article indicate that it is the more structurally or featurally complex complements that allow BNC in the matrix clause. Crucially, that is the exact opposite of what would be expected under a movement-based account. In fact, in his book Grano (2015), Grano argues that partial control predicates have CP complements and involve PRO-control, while exhaustive control predicates are restructuring predicates and involve thematic raising.

Another piece of data that would be problematic for a movement-based account is the fact that the controller NCI can bear a different case from FQs in the embedded clause (which agree with the DPs they are predicated of, in this case the trace of the controller). This is shown in (42).



- (42) Profesor predupredil **nikogo** ne podnimat' čemodan **samomu**.  
 professor warned nobody.ACC NEG lift.INF suitcase oneself.DAT  
 'Professor warned everyone to not lift the suitcase on their own.'

Case transmission and independence facts are not trivial to account for under any theory of control. However, a PRO-based theory provides a necessary distinction between the null element in the controlled complement and the controller, while a movement-based account ties the two together as copies of each other. As is discussed in Section 3.1, the 'second dative' cannot be considered a default case and has to come from agreeing with the subject of the controlled complement. Given that, I consider the case mismatch exemplified in (42) to be evidence in favor of a PRO-based theory of control structures with BNC.

Based on these considerations, I conclude that despite its appearance Backward Negative Concord should be accounted for under a PRO-based theory of control, and as such, presents an additional argument in its favor.

## 5. Predictions.

5.1. PREDICTIONS FOR RUSSIAN. One prediction that this analysis makes is that the checked [*uNEG*] feature could get transmitted to non-quantificational DP-controllers in case of embedded  $C_{[uNEG]}$  as well. This potentially means that negative floating quantifiers (adverbial uses of *ni*-pronouns as FQs agreeing in case with a corresponding DP) can also be licensed. That is, indeed, the case.

- (43) Rebjata **nikto** rešili ne prixodit'.  
 Guys.NOM nobody.NOM decided NEG come.INF  
 'The guys all (of them) decided not to come.'

Since this analysis assigns the responsibility for BNC licensing to the same negative complementizer that mediates long-distance negative concord, the prediction is that in case long-distance negative concord is not possible, Backward Negative Concord should also be out. Another complement control structure that this can be tested against is a *wh*-infinitival. Long-distance NC turns out to be unavailable for control into *wh*-infinitives (44).

- (44) \*Ja **ne** znaju [kak **nikogo** poprosit' o pomošči].  
 I NEG know how nobody.ACC ask.INF about help  
 Int.: 'I don't know how to ask anyone for help.'

Expectedly, Backward Negative Concord is also not possible in these structures.

- (45) \***Nikto** znajet [kak **ne** svintit'sja]  
 nobody knows how NEG screw.INF  
 Int.: 'Everyone knows how not to get detained.'

One more prediction can be inferred based on the unavailability of  $C_{[uNEG]}$ . Recall, that some predicates with 'negative' meaning have been argued to select for negative complementizers (Laka 1992, Progovac 1993b, Landau 2002). The main kind of evidence for such negative complementizers comes from licensing NPIs in clausal complements of such verbs together with

the unavailability of such licensing in their nominal complements. Such control predicates should not be able to license Backward Negative Concord, since the complementizer in their complement has to bear [*i*NEG], and, hence, cannot smuggle a checked [*u*NEG] feature to the controller.

Indeed, this can be shown for the predicates *otkazat'sja* ‘to refuse’ and *otgovorit'* ‘to talk out of’. BNC is allowed with their ‘positive’ counterparts *soglasit'sja* ‘to agree’<sup>12</sup> (46) and *ugovorit'* ‘to talk into’ (49).

- (46) Context: at a meeting, there was a discussion of a potential problem. The members decided to worry about it later.

**Nikto** soglasilsja [poka ob etom **ne** zamoračivat'sja].  
nobody.NOM agreed for.now about this NEG worry.INF  
‘Everyone agreed to not worry about it for now.’

- (47) Ravvin ugovoril **nikogo** [**ne** vyxodit' iz zala].  
rabbi talked.into nobody.ACC NEG exit.INF from hall  
‘The rabbi talked everyone into not leaving the hall.’

It is, however, disallowed with the ‘negative’ predicates.

- (48) \***Nikto** otkazalsja [**ne** obraščat' na eto vnimanija].  
nobody.NOM refused NEG turn.INF on this attention  
Int.: ‘Everyone refused to ignore this. (=not pay attention to it)’

- (49) \*Ravvin otgovoril **nikogo** [**ne** vyxodit' iz zala].  
rabbi talked.out.of nobody.ACC NEG exit.INF from hall  
Int.: ‘The rabbi talked everyone out of not leaving the hall.’

One more thing needs to be noted as far as the consequences of the proposed analysis go. Since, just like dative case assignment in control infinitives, this analysis relies on the interaction between PRO and the embedded C head, Backward Negative Concord licensing can be expected to interact with the availability of ‘second dative’. In fact, it does not seem to. BNC does not depend on the presence of ‘second dative’: it is possible when PRO is not dative (see 42), and also when it is (50).

- (50) Ravvin ubedil **nikogo** [ne vyxodit' iz zala **odnogo**].  
rabbi persuaded.PFV nobody.ACC NEG exit.INF from hall alone.ACC  
‘The rabbi persuaded everyone not to leave the hall alone.’

The analysis of BNC needs to be checked against an analysis of ‘second datives’. That is, however, problematic. An account suggested in the study of Russian case transmission facts Landau (2008) faces several empirical and conceptual challenges. Firstly, it relies on the earlier Agree model of control (Landau 2001). Among its unsatisfactory aspects, Landau (2015) names the unclear nature of what triggers downward Agree between matrix T and PRO. Secondly, Landau (2008) assumes that control complement CPs are weak phases in Russian. Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023) show, using A-scrambling as a diagnostic, that at least object control

12. This was originally noticed in Kholodilova (2015)

complements do behave as phases. Another issue is that Landau (2008) relies on C cliticizing on the next head up the tree (V and *v* for subject control, Appl for object control) to derive the difference in case transmission pattern in subject and object control (and other kinds of control complements). However, this results in C assigning dative to PRO from after adjoining to a higher head, and hence, not under *c*-command. The matter of refining an account of Russian case transmission in control structures is plainly beyond the scope of this article. Thus, the interaction of BNC and case transmission mechanisms cannot be addressed here.

5.2. CROSS-LINGUISTIC PREDICTIONS. The fact that BNC has not, to the best of my knowledge, been reported for many other languages before suggests that the circumstances allowing their occurrence are somewhat unique. Any analysis of BNC in Russian must answer why BNC is not attested in every (strict) negative concord language with infinitival control complements.

The proposal in this article is motivated based on another less widespread property of Russian to answer that question. As discussed in Section 4.1, Russian exhibits long-distance negative concord (LDNC) in non-restructuring contexts.

The possibility of LDNC with any obligatory control complement contrasts with reported data for other negative concord languages. Grano 2015:22–24 provides the locality profile of negative concord in Italian (a non-strict negative concord language): matrix negation can only license NCIs like *niente* ‘nothing’ in the embedded clause with restructuring predicates. Similar facts are also reported later in Grano 2015:189–193 for Greek, a strict negative concord language, based on Giannakidou & Quer (1997).

Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023) suggest that LDNC is made possible by a complementizer with an uninterpretable feature that mediates long-distance NC. The proposal in this article relies on that complementizer to create an environment for the  $[\mu\text{NEG}]$  feature to be transferred to the matrix clause and, hence, for BNC to occur. That means that the exact prediction the current proposal is making is that if a language exhibits BNC it, hence, has true long-distance negative concord. Thus, if there is no evidence of a  $C_{[\mu\text{NEG}]}$  (e.g. no LDNC), it is not expected to exhibit BNC.

Specifically, languages for which LDNC is reported to not be possible with non-restructuring matrix predicates (Italian, Grano 2015, Greek, Giannakidou & Quer 1997, BCMS, Progovac 1993a) are predicted not to exhibit BNC. This prediction is rather trivial since it has the same consequences as the default assumptions about Negative Concord, rather, that BNC structures should not be possible. It only adds a restriction on the class of languages/cases where it isn’t. The crucial prediction is that if a strict negative concord language has LDNC (or other evidence of a  $C_{[\mu\text{NEG}]}$ ), it can be expected to exhibit BNC. Importantly, as I show in Section 7, a CP layer in the controlled infinitive is necessary but not always sufficient to make BNC possible. Hence, in the current stage of this proposal, it can only predict the *possibility* of BNC in such languages rather than its certainty.

The one other language reported to have BNC is Khanty, a Uralic language (Kholodilova 2015). There is, however, no data on LDNC in Khanty available to me. Another languages that could be expected to have instances of BNC, based on the  $C_{[\mu\text{NEG}]}$  suggested in Landau (2002) is Hebrew. Checking these cross-linguistics predictions in comparison to cases where a CP layer is insufficient to give rise to BNC (see Section 7) should help fine-grain the analysis of BNC.

**6. Try-class predicates.** In this Section, I discuss Backward Negative Concord with *try*-class predicates. Firstly, I argue that try-class predicates are not like other predicates that are classi-

fied as restructuring predicates. Secondly, I show that BNC is possible with try-predicates and propose that the mechanism behind it is the same as the rest of subject control BNC discussed in Section 4.

6.1. STATUS. *Try*-class predicates are typically classified as restructuring predicates (Wurmbrand 2001). Indeed, *try*-class predicates in Russian, like aspectual and implicative subject control predicates are, in Landau's terms, semantically tenseless: do not allow conflicting temporal modification.

- (51) \*Včera Polja staralas'/ pytalas'/ probovala zavtra prijti.  
 yesterday Polya tried attempted tried tomorrow come.INF  
 Int.: 'Yesterday Polya tried to make it so that she comes tomorrow.'

Landau (2015) classifies *try*-class as nonattitude and, hence, semantically untensed exhaustive control predicates. Building on the work in Sharvit (2003), Grano (2011), Grano (2017) proposes an analysis of *try* treating it as an unusual aspectual kind of propositional attitude predicate. The denotation he proposes for *John tried to open the door* in Grano 2017:10 is shown in (52).

- (52)  $\exists e[Ag(e, j) \wedge \forall w' \in INT_{j,w} : \exists e'[e \subset_{init} e' \wedge open(e') \wedge Ag(e', j) \wedge Th(e', d) \text{ in } w']]$   
 $\approx$  'There is some event *e* whose agent is John and all worlds compatible with John's intentions in *w* are worlds in which *e* is an initial stage of some event *e'* which is an opening event whose agent is John and whose theme is the door'

Under these semantics, the conflicting temporal modification of the matrix event *e* and the intended outcome *e'* would lead to a contradiction because *e* is in a part-whole relationship with *e'*.

Under Landau (2015)'s view, this suggests that *try*-class predicates' complements may be more structurally complex. I believe there are three facts about Russian *try*-predicates that point to that conclusion.

Firstly, the only diagnostic for restructuring that can be implemented in Russian is the one having to do with embedded temporal reference. However, the unavailability of conflicting temporal modification does not definitively signal the absence of a TP layer altogether. As shown by Grano, this unavailability may be the result of a contradiction due to the special semantics of *try*.

Secondly, unlike other restructuring predicates, *try*-predicates in Russian do not restrict the embedded aspect no matter the matrix aspect.

(53)–(54) show that both perfective and imperfective *try*-predicates can have either perfective or imperfective verbs in their complement. Concerning this, *try*-predicates pattern with attitude subject control predicates.

- (53) a. Katja staralas' pročitat' Brat'ev Karamazovyx (k Ponedel'niku).  
 Katya tried.IPV read.PFV.INF Brothers Karamazov (by Monday)  
 'Katya tried to read Brothers Karamazov (by Monday).'
- b. Katja staralas' čitat' Brat'ev Karamazovyx (po utram).  
 Katya tried.IPV read.IPV.INF Brothers Karamazov (every morning)  
 'Katya tried to read Brothers Karamazov (every morning).'

- (54) a. Katja postaralas' pročitat' Brat'ev Karamazovyx (k ponedel'niku).  
 Katya tried.PFV read.PFV.INF Brothers Karamazov (by Monday)  
 'Katya tried to read Brothers Karamazov (by Monday).'
- b. Katja postaralas' čitat' Brat'ev Karamazovyx (medlenno i četko).  
 Katya tried.PFV read.IPV.INF Brothers Karamazov (slowly and clearly)  
 'Katya tried to read Brothers Karamazov slowly and clearly.'

The picture is different for aspectual (trivially, 55) or implicative subject control predicates (56). Aspectual predicates can only have imperfective complements.

- (55) Nast'a načinala pisat'/\*napisat' stat'ju.  
 Nastya began.IPV write.IPV.INF write.PFV.INF article  
 'Nastya was starting to write a article.'

Implicatives restrict embedded aspect to perfective in case the matrix verb is perfective. If the matrix verb is imperfective, the embedded verb can also be imperfective.

- (56) a. Nastja zabyla prijti/\*prijodit'.  
 Nastya forgot.PFV come.PFV.INF come.IPV.INF  
 'Nastya forgot to come.'
- b. Nastja zabывala prijti/prijodit'.  
 Nastya forgot.PFV come.PFV.INF come.IPV.INF  
 'Nastya (repeatedly) forgot to come.'

These aspect restrictions for implicatives make sense if restructuring structures denote the same event. In case the matrix predicate is imperfective, meaning that the reference time is included in event time, the subevent time can both include reference time (imperfective) and be included in reference time (perfective). However, if the matrix clause predicate is perfective, meaning that the event time is included in reference time, no subevent can include reference time.

Finally, unlike other restructuring predicates, *try*-predicates sometimes allow partial control readings.

- (57) a. Mama<sub>i</sub> staralas' [PRO<sub>i+</sub> (vsegda) užinat' vmeste].  
 mom tried (always) have.dinner.INF together  
 'Mom tried to always have dinner together (as a family).'
- b. \*Mama<sub>i</sub> uspela [PRO<sub>i+</sub> použinat' vmeste].  
 mom tried always have.dinner.INF  
 'Mom managed to have dinner together (as a family) in time.'

Based on the attitudinal semantics for *try* proposed in Grano (2017), the marginal acceptability of Partial Control, the lack of definitive language-internal restructuring diagnostics for Russian (i.e. clitic climbing), and the fact that *try*-predicates pattern with other attitude predicates with respect to aspect restrictions, I conclude that *try*-predicate complements in Russian can be CPs.

6.2. BNC WITH *try*-PREDICATES. I suggest that *try*-predicates do involve a CP-layer responsible for encoding the embedded attitude coordinates. That explains the fact that *try*-predicates allow Backward Negative Concord.<sup>13</sup>

- (58) **Nikto** staralsja/ pytalsja [ob etom **ne** dumat’].  
 nobody.NOM tried/ attempted about this NEG think.sc inf  
 ‘Everyone tried not to think about it.’

Under the restructuring analysis of *try*, it could be suggested that the restructuring nature of *try*-predicates allows for NCIs to be licensed in the matrix clause since the structure is actually monoclausal and, hence, contains a clausemate negation. In the following part of this Section, I show that this is not the case because the only position in which a *ni*-pronoun is licensed is still the subject – the controller.

With *try*-class predicates, it can be hard to distinguish between embedded and matrix modification. One kind of ambiguity with adjunction in *try*-class complements is illustrated in (59). In this example, it is possible to tell whether *before the meeting began* is attached in the embedded clause or the matrix clause from interpretation: in case of embedded clause attachment, (59) suggests that Fred intended to have the minutes before the meeting began; in case of matrix clause attachment, (59) means that Fred was trying before the meeting began (the minutes might actually have nothing to do with the meeting).

- (59) from Larson 2002:9  
 Fred was trying to find the minutes **before the meeting began**. (ambiguous)

Using *before*-adjuncts, it can be shown that with *try*-class predicates *ni*-adjuncts are not licensed when base-generated in the matrix clause (60a) while *ni*-subjects are (60b).

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13. There is one predicate of the *try*-class that is degraded with BNC: *probovat* ‘to try/attempt’.

- (i) ??Nikto proboval [ob etom ne dumat’].  
 nobody.NOM attempted about it NEG think.sc inf  
 Int.: ‘Everyone attempted not to think about it.’

This predicate shares the properties of *try*-class predicates concerning temporal modification and aspectual restrictions: embedded clause cannot admit conflicting temporal modifiers but can have either perfective or imperfective aspect independent of the matrix aspect. One difference between *probovat* and the other *try*-class predicates is that it is the only one that can take a DP complement and express the meaning in (2)–(3).

- (ii) Ira poprobovala/ \*postaralas’ novyj kofe.  
 Ira tried/ tried new coffee  
 ‘Ira tried a new coffee.’
- (iii) Olja probovala [katat’sja na lyžax].  
 Olya tried ride.INF on skis  
 ‘Olya has tried skiing. (=has the experience)’

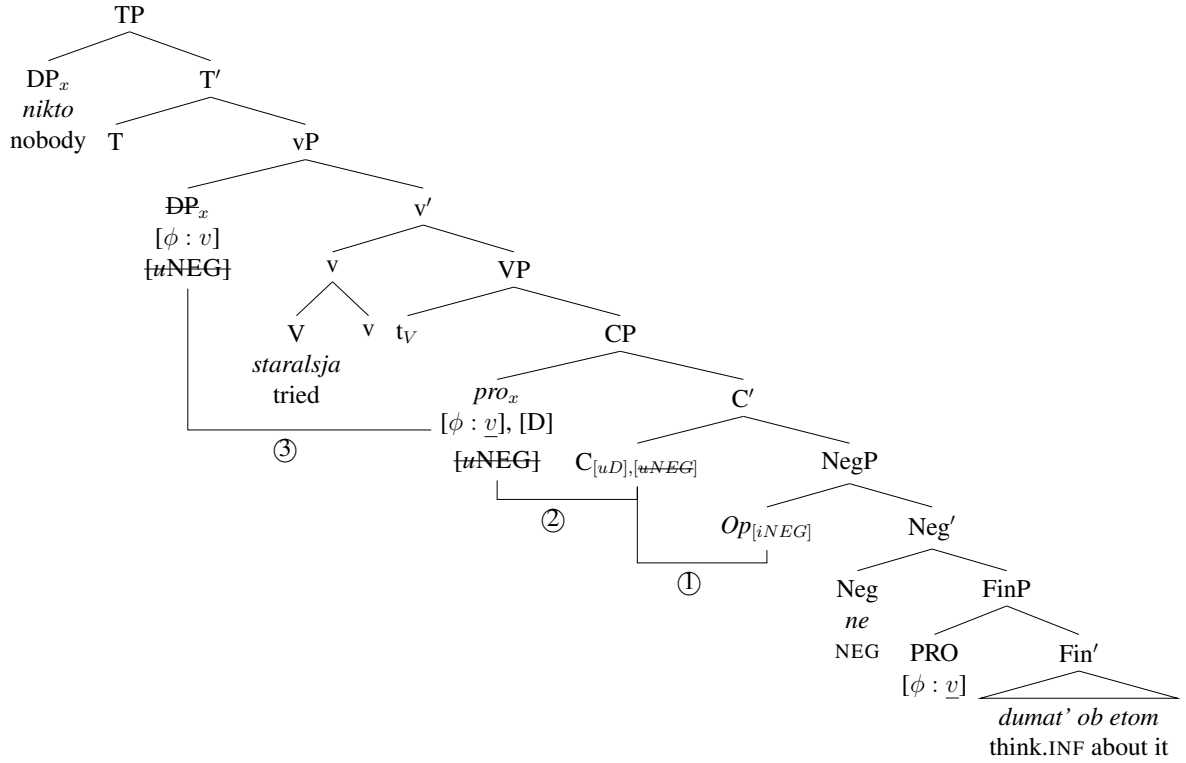
So far it remains unclear what specific difference is behind this predicate’s anomalous behavior with respect to BNC.

- (60) a. Petja staralsja **ne** est' kašu [pered maminym prixodom].  
 Petya tried NEG eat.INF porridge before mom's arrival  
 i. 'Before mom's arrival, Petya was trying not to eat the porridge.'  
 ii. 'Petya tried not to eat the porridge before mom's arrival. (e.g. he wanted to wait for her and start eating together)'
- b. #(**ni pered čjim prixodom**) Petja staralsja **ne** est' kašu (ni pered  
 NCI before whose arrival Petya tried NEG eat.INF porridge NCI before  
 čjim prixodom).  
 whose arrival  
 i. Int.: \*'Before everyone came, Petya was trying not to eat the porridge.'  
 ii. 'Petya tried not to eat the porridge before anyone's arrival.' (e.g. wanted to make sure everyone was there to start eating together)

In (60)a, the adjunct is at the end of the sentence and its attachment is ambiguous, which gives rise to two interpretations in i. and ii. (60)b shows that, no matter whether the corresponding NCI-adjunct is at the end of the sentence or left-dislocated to make matrix interpretation more likely, the NCI-adjunct can only be interpreted in the embedded clause where it is licensed by clausemate negation. As is illustrated in (58), an NCI-subject is licensed in the same contexts. I take that to be evidence that with *try*-class predicates, just like the rest of subject control predicates, the subject is the only position in the matrix clause where NCIs can be licensed by embedded negation.

Considering (i.) Grano (2017)'s analysis of *try*-predicates; (ii.) Landau's two-tiered theory connecting attitude control complements to a CP-layer; (iii.) *try*-predicates patterning with attitude predicates concerning aspect restrictions; (iv.) the fact that, like in other BNC cases, NCIs are only licensed by embedded negation in the subject (controller) position of *try*-predicates, I conclude that the analysis proposed in Section 4 can be extended to Backward Negative Concord with *try*-predicates. This is illustrated in (61) for the sentence in (62).

(61) Derivation of BNC with *try*-predicates = logophoric subject control BNC



- (62) Nikto staralsja [ne dumat' ob etom].  
 nobody.NOM tried NEG think.INF about this  
 'Everyone tried not to think about it.'

Given the presence of a C-layer in the complement, the mechanism deriving BNC structures with *try*-predicates is the same as with logophoric subject control.

**7. Extensions.** The analysis proposed in this article is based on the generalization that a CP layer is necessary for BNC to become possible. This Section discusses cases in which the apparent presence of a CP layer is not sufficient to license BNC.

**7.1. FACTIVE PREDICATES.** Three factive predicates take infinitival complements: *ljubit'* 'love', *nenavidet'* 'hate', *ustat'* 'to get tired of'. Landau (2015) classifies factives together with the rest of attitude predicates: allowing partial control, semantically 'tensed', exhibiting logophoric control. However, with respect to embedded tense and aspect, these predicates pattern with nonattitude restructuring verbs.

These predicates do not allow conflicting temporal modification in their complement:

- (63) \*Segodnja Šura ustal [včera begat'].  
 today Shura got.tired yesterday run.INF  
 Int.: 'Today, Shura got tired of running yesterday.'



- (64) \*Segodnja Petja ljubit/ nenavidit [rabotat' včera].  
 today Petya loves/ hates work.INF yesterday  
 Int.: 'Today, Petya loves having worked yesterday.'

They also restrict the aspect of the embedded complement:<sup>14</sup>

- (65) Nastja ustala/ nenavidela pisat'/ \*napisat' statji.  
 Nastya tired.of hated write.IPV.INF write.PFV.INF articles  
 'Nastya hated to write articles.'

Another thing in which factives pattern with restructuring verbs is BNC licensing. Backward Negative Concord is not allowed with these verbs.

- (66) \*Nikto ljubil/ nenavidel [ne rabotat'].  
 Nobody.NOM loved/ hated NEG work.INF  
 Int.: 'Everyone loved/hated not to work.'
- (67) Context: Kids are playing a game in which one person signals the rest to freeze until they pronounce a code word. The person whose turn it is to signal is taking a very long time to release everyone from the need to stay still.  
 \*Nikto ustal [ne dvigat'sja].  
 nobody.NOM got.tired NEG move.INF  
 Int: 'Everyone got tired of not moving.'

Table 2 summarizes the properties of factives in comparison to other subject control predicates.

14. The verb *ljubit* 'to love' mostly prefers imperfective complements. However, there is a specific iterative 'from time to time' meaning that arises when the complement is perfective. Notably, that is not the meaning expected from perfectives.

- (i) a. Petja ljubil pisat' pis'ma.  
 Petya loved write.IPV.INF letters  
 'Petya loved writing letters.'
- b. Petja ljubil napisat' pis'mo.  
 Petya loved write.PFV.INF pis'mo.  
 'From time to time, Petya enjoyed writing a letter.'

This perfective complement can be modified with *inogda* 'sometimes' even when the matrix predicate is perfective itself (2)a, even though perfectives cannot normally be modified by this adverb (2)b–c.

- (ii) a. San Sanyč poljubil inogda vypit'.  
 San Sanych began.to.love.PFV sometimes drink.PFV.INF  
 'San Sanych started loving to have a drink sometimes.'
- b. \*San Sanyč inogda poljubil kartošku.  
 San Sanych sometimes began.to.love.PFV potato.
- c. \*San Sanyč inogda vypil.  
 San Sanych sometimes drink.PFV

| Matrix predicate | BNC | Conflicting T modification | Embedded aspect independence | Attitude | PC |
|------------------|-----|----------------------------|------------------------------|----------|----|
| Attitude         | ✓   | ✓                          | ✓                            | ✓        | ✓  |
| Try-class        | ✓   | ✗                          | ✓                            | ✓        | ?  |
| Factives         | ✗   | ✗                          | ✗                            | ✓        | ✓  |
| Restructuring    | ✗   | ✗                          | ✗                            | ✗        | ✗  |

Table 2. Structure size diagnostics, BNC, and factive predicates

Table 2 shows that the factives discussed in this Section show mixed properties between subject control verbs selecting for full CP-complements and restructuring verbs. It is for now not clear what role these properties play in disallowing Backward Negative Concord. Following the analysis of BNC proposed in this article, it could be expected that if a) the infinitival complement is a CP, and b) the structure allows long-distance negative concord, then BNC would also be allowed. That is, long-distance negative concord into CP-infinitives is mediated by C carrying a [*u*NEG] feature (Lyutikova & Gerasimova 2023), which signals the availability of this kind of C in this structure. This complementizer could be able to trigger BNC with factives, contrary to fact. The matter of what blocks BNC in these cases remains to be resolved. It may provide additional insight into the mixed characteristics of factives discussed in this Section.

7.2. ADJUNCT CONTROL. BNC is made possible by control, hence, there is another kind of control that needs to be addressed here. That is, does BNC show up with obligatory control into adjuncts? Do controlled adjuncts differ with respect to allowing BNC?

Since most adjuncts are opaque to valuation out of them, it seems to be expected that BNC should not be possible with adjunct control. That is, indeed, the case. However, BNC is impossible even with purpose adjuncts (68)a that are otherwise transparent, for example, for *wh*-movement (68)b.

- (68) a. \***Nikto**<sub>i</sub> prixodil [PRO<sub>i</sub> ne vpuskat' xuliganov].  
 Nobody came NEG let.in.INF hooligan.  
 'Int.: Everyone came to not let bullies in.'
- b. Kogo Petja prixodil [vpuskat' \_\_\_]?  
 who.ACC Petya came let.in.INF  
 'Who did Petya come to let in?'

Due to considerations of space, a detailed discussion of the consequences of the lack of BNC in adjunct control cases is not in the scope of the current article. A possible account could be imagined if the transparent purpose clauses are smaller than CPs and, hence, lack the necessary environment for BNC to occur. The unavailability of BNC with opaque controlled adjuncts is also not trivial to account for. The mechanism underlying adjuncts' opacity to valuation out of them needs to be modified to rule out 'flagging' under an Agree relation that has already been established (for the purpose of valuating PRO's  $\phi$ -features *into* the adjunct). A detailed analysis of BNC with adjunct control remains to be developed in further work.

**8. Backward Negative Concord with Raising.** Russian is typically not considered among languages attesting Raising to Subject from infinitivals. There are, however, some predicates exhibiting properties typical of raising. Raising to subject should be able to produce Backward Negative Concord-like structures parallel to the ones discussed in this article. Indeed, if the NCI originates in the embedded clause that has negation, the [*u*NEG] feature can be checked before the NCI moves to the matrix clause. This appendix provides a few examples of what I consider to be raising predicates in Russian and BNC structures with them.

Minor (2013) uses the licensing of *-nibud'* pronouns which can only be licensed in non-veridical contexts as one of the tests for embedded interpretation of the controller in object control structures. There are at least two subject control verbs that pass this test.<sup>15</sup> One such verb is *obeščat* 'promise': even though it can act as a regular subject control predicate and assign a theta role to its subject, there seems to be a raising version of this predicate. (69)a shows that *nibud'* pronouns can be licensed in the subject of *obeščat* 'promise', (69)b shows that it is not possible in the absence of an embedded infinitive, (69)c shows that the pronoun can be licensed in the embedded clause. Following Minor (2013), Lyutikova & Tatevosov (2020), I take that to mean that the subject is interpreted in the embedded clause – reconstruction typical for raising.

- (69) a. Kto-**nibud'** obeščal [pomoč].  
           who-nibud' promised help.INF  
           'Someone or other promised to help.'
- b. \*Kto-**nibud'** obeščal grozu.  
           who-nibud' promised storm  
           Int.: 'Someone or other promised a storm.'
- c. Vera obeščala [kogo-**nibud'** ubit'].  
           Vera promised who-nubud' kill.INF  
           'Vera promised to kill someone or other.'

Another subject control verb exhibiting this kind of dual behavior is *riskovat* 'risk'. (70) shows a parallel paradigm with *nibud'* pronouns for *riskovat* 'risk' as is shown above for *obeščat* 'promise'.

- (70) a. Kto-**nibud'** riskuet [upast'].  
           who-nibud' risks fall.INF  
           'Someone or other risks falling.'
- b. \*Kto-**nibud'** riskuet svoimi denigami.  
           who-nibud' risks REFL money.INST  
           Int.: 'Someone or other is risking their own money.'
- c. Vera riskuet [kogo-**nibud'** ubit'].  
           Vera risks who-nubud' kill.INF  
           'Vera risks killing someone or other.'

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15. I thank Sergei Minor for sharing this observation.

Other properties indicating the raising nature of constructions with these two verbs are the following. The possibility of an inanimate subject shows the lack of selectional restrictions on the subject (71). Idiomatic reading can be preserved (72). No change to truth conditions under passive can only be shown for *riskovat* ‘risk’, animate DPs in the subject position of *obeščat* ‘promise’ seem to force theta-role assignment and subject control.

- (71) a. ...metodika obeščæt [pomoč za dve nedeli].  
 method promises help.INF in 2 weeks  
 ‘...method promises to help in 2 weeks’
- b. ...metodika riskuet [navredit’].  
 method promises harm.INF  
 ‘...method risks doing harm’
- (72) a. Larčik obeščal prosto otkryt’sja.  
 casket promised easily open.INF  
 ‘It promised to be easy to solve.’
- b. Ego žaba riskuet zadužit’.  
 he.ACC toad risks strangle.INF  
 ‘There is a risk of him getting too greedy.’
- (73) a. Xirurg riskuet ubit’ pacient-a  
 surgeon risks kill.INF patient-ACC  
 ≈‘There’s a risk that the surgeon will kill the patient.’
- b. Pacient riskujet byt’ ubit-ym xirurg-om  
 patient risks be.INF killed-INSTR surgeon-INSTR  
 ≈‘There’s a risk that the patient will be killed by the surgeon.’

As can be predicted, Backward Negative Concord is possible with the raising readings of *obeščat* ‘promise’, *riskovat* ‘risk’.

- (74) Ničego obeščæt ne vyjti.  
 nothing promises NEG work.out.INF  
 ‘It looks like nothing is going to work out.’
- (75) from [forum](#)  
 Na ego koncert nikto riskuet ne pojti.  
 on his concert nobody risks NEG go.INF  
 ‘There is a risk that nobody will come to his concert.’

Importantly, these examples differ from BNC with control verbs in the interpretation of the NCI subject. While with control the NCI is interpreted as a universal quantifier in the matrix clause (and, hence, above negation), the NCIs in (74)–(75) are interpreted in the embedded clause. When an NCI is interpreted with local negation, the narrow-scope existential and wide-scope universal readings are equivalent.

**9. Conclusion.** In this article, I have shown that as the result of the control relationship established between the embedded clause and the controller, a checked [*u*NEG] feature can be transmitted to the controller, resulting in what I call backward negative control. Following Lyutikova & Gerasimova (2023), I propose that the element responsible for the introduction of that feature in the embedded structure is a special (negative) complementizer. Thus, control predicates with complements big enough to include C allow backward negative control. Given this generalization, I argued against a movement-based account of BNC (and, hence, control in general). This article also argues in favor of the idea that feature transfer under Agree can be bidirectional (Deal 2022). As a result, features can not only be transmitted from the controller to PRO but something can also be transmitted back to the controller as a by-product.

The proposed analysis views BNC as morphological concord that becomes possible due to the interaction of (i) the availability of a special kind of complementizer C which bears a feature responsible for NCI morphology; (ii) the relationship between C and the null element (pro/PRO) that allows for transfer of that feature to pro/PRO; (iii) the bidirectional feature transfer under the Agree relationship established between the controller and the null subject element in the infinitival complement. In this article I follow Zeijlstra (2004), Zeijlstra (2008) in assuming that the feature responsible for the *ni*-morphology is [*u*NEG]. Note, however, that the same analysis can be reformulated in the system proposed in Deal (2021), where the NCIs are goals for the probe on the negative operator, and their NCI-morphology is the result of spelling out an element that has interacted with negation and, thus, has been ‘flagged’ with an [I | NEG] feature.

Another theory that this article’s results are relevant for is the theory put forth in Grano (2015) analyzing control in restructuring predicates as thematic raising. The data in this article contradicts this analysis: it is exactly the restructuring predicates that do not allow backward negative licensing. That is unexpected on the view that the controller in such structures originated in a position with local negation. A possible way of reconciling BNC and restructuring control as thematic raising could come from the view that  $\theta$ -raising, unlike A-raising, cannot reconstruct at LF (Bondarenko 2021). Data in the appendix shows that A-raising of *ni*-pronouns out of negated infinitives is grammatical and the *ni*-pronoun in such contexts (necessarily) reconstructs in the embedded clause. Data in Section 2.3 also show that *ni*-phrases can be scrambled out of negated infinitives into the main clause. They, of course, also reconstruct in the embedded clause. It is possible that movement only licenses BNC if it reconstructs in the embedded clause at LF. The nature of this potential restriction remains for further investigation. Such an account, however, would get rid of the advantage a movement-based theory has for accounting for BNC, namely, the possibility of licensing the matrix NCI in the embedded clause.

**Appendix.** For reasons of space, the main body of the paper only has a few examples to illustrate the division among predicates into those that allow BNC and those that do not. In this appendix, I provide additional examples to provide further illustration.

- Subject control: attitude predicates

(76) Context: The committee decided to prolong the meeting a little more and discuss the last action item, because:

(V sledujuščij raz) **nikto** bojalsja [ob etom **ne** vspomnit’].  
 in next time nobody.NOM feared about this NEG remember.INF  
 ‘Everyone was afraid of not remembering about this (next time).’

- (77) (Russian National Corpus)  
 ...**nikto** predpočitaet [**ne** vspominat' [čto nyněšnj den' zaščitnika  
 nobody.NOM prefers NEG recall.INF that today's day defender.GEN  
 otečestva <...>]]  
 fatherland.GEN  
 'Everyone prefers to not recall that today's Defender of the Fatherland day...<...>'
- (78) Context: At a business meeting, there was a discussion of a potential problem that every-  
 one decided to set aside for now.  
**Nikto** soglasilsja [poka ob etom **ne** zamoračivat'sja].  
 nobody.NOM yet about it NEG bother.INF  
 'Everyone agreed not to bother thinking about it for now.'
- (79) **Nikto** planiruet/ sobiraetsja [**ne** prijti].  
 nobody.NOM plans/ intends NEG come.INF  
 'Everyone plans/intends to not come.'
- (80) **Nikto** xotel [**ne** obraščat' na eto vnimanija].  
 nobody.NOM wanted NEG turn.INF on this attention  
 'Everyone wanted not to pay attention to this (=to ignore)'
- (81) **Nikto** obeščal [**ne** napivat'sja]  
 nobody.NOM promised NEG get.drunk.INF  
 'Everyone promised not to get drunk.'
- (82) Context: The meeting is running very late, the last train into the city is leaving soon. Un-  
 less the meeting ends right now,  
**Nikto** riskuet [**ne** uspet' na poezd].  
 nobody.NOM risks NEG manage.in.time.INF on train  
 'Everyone is risking missing the train.'
- Object control
    - Speech act causative verbs:
- (83) from Minor (2013)  
 Petja prikazal **nikomu** sjuda **ne** zaxodit'.  
 Petya ordered nobody.DAT here NEG come.in.INF  
 'Petya ordered that nobody enter here.'

- (84) (Russian National Corpus)  
 Predsedatel' poprosil **nikogo** **ne** obizhat'sja.  
 chair asked nobody.ACC NEG get.offended.INF  
 'The chair asked for nobody to get offended.'
- (85) from Minor (2013)  
 Petja prikazal **nikomu** sjuda **ne** zaxodit'.  
 Petya ordered nobody.DAT here NEG come.in.INF  
 'Petya ordered that nobody enter here.'
- (86) (Russian National Corpus)  
 Predsedatel' poprosil **nikogo** **ne** obizhat'sja.  
 chair asked nobody.ACC NEG get.offended.INF  
 'The chair asked for nobody to get offended.'
- Implicatives:
- (87) from [\[ranobe website\]](#)  
 Žar zastavil **nikogo** **ne** približat'sja k nemu.  
 heat forced nobody.ACC NEG approach.INF to him  
 'The heat made everyone not come close to him.'
- Conatives:
- (88) a. from [www.ntv.ru](#)  
 Ravvin ubedil **nikogo** **ne** vyxodit' iz zala.  
 rabbi persuaded.PFV nobody.ACC NEG exit.INF from hall  
 'The rabbi persuaded everyone not to leave the hall.'
- b. Vrač ubeždal **nikogo** **ne** privivat'sja.  
 doctor persuaded.IPV nobody.ACC NEG get.vaccinated.INF  
 'The doctor tried to persuade everyone not to get vaccinated.'

Section 3.2 discusses the results of CP-level diagnostics applied to predicates under investigation. A particular diagnostic is availability of independent temporal modification. While the main text contains the summary of the results, I provide the data for that diagnostic here.

- Subject control: attitude predicates
- (89) **Včera**, Nataša rešila/ sobiralas'/ obeščala **zavtra** prijtī.  
 yesterday Natasha decided intended promised tomorrow come.INF  
 'Yesterday, Natasha decided/intended/promised to come tomorrow.'

- Subject control: restructuring predicates

- (90) \***Včera** Rada zabyvala [**zavtra** ne slušat' Verinyx sovetov].  
 yesterday Rada forgot tomorrow NEG listen.INF Vera's advice  
 Int.: 'Yesterday Rada kept forgetting not to listen to Vera's advice tomorrow.'
- (91) \***Zavtra** Darina prekratit/ perestanet [**segodnja** ne slušat'sja].  
 tomorrow Darina will.stop will.stop today NEG obey.INF
- Object control
- (92) Speech act causation verbs  
**Včera** učitel' velel/ prikazal/ posovetoval/ razrešil Naste **zavtra**  
 yesterday teacher ordered ordered advised permitted Nastya.DAT tomorrow  
 propustit' zanjatie.  
 skip.INF class  
 'Yesterday, the teacher ordered/advised/permitted Nastya to skip class tomorrow.'
- (93) Speech act conative verbs  
**Včera** učitel ubedil/ ubeždal Nastju **segodnja** prijeti v  
 yesterday teacher persuaded.PFV persuaded.IPV Nastya.ACC today come.INF in  
 školu.  
 school  
 'Yesterday, the teacher persuaded/tried to persuade Nastya to come to school today.'
- (94) **Včera** Katja napomnila Natashe **zavtra** pozvonit' mame.  
 yesterday Katya reminded Natasha.DAT tomorrow call.INF mom  
 'Yesterday, Katya reminded Natasha to call her mom tomorrow.'
- (95) **Včera** Katja predupredila Natashu **zavtra** ne zvonit' mame.  
 yesterday Katya warned Natasha.DACC tomorrow NEG call.INF mom  
 'Yesterday, Katya warned Natasha not to call her mom tomorrow.'

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